is there a political 'instance' capable of defining and implementing projects as a 'rational' task, related to the idealisation of entrepreneurial activity, transferred to the activity of managers, politicians or think tanks operating nationally and internationally. Projects, clashes and struggles are the basic foundation and most concrete forms of historicity. The organising role of political and associational bodies (and of their proponents and managers) is basic to the conduct of such clashes. Nevertheless, we do not always come across clear and well-defined struggles or neat class divisions; many times class struggles occur in a subtle manner by means of innumerable quiet tensions. The result is therefore not linear; history is not teleology and even the most powerful capitalist sectors do not decide its course.[3] In fact, these sectors have many powers: they dominate, conspire, manipulate and are temporarily able to shape, accelerate as well as delay tendencies. But active contradictions arise unceasingly and social struggles assume chameleon-like and changing shapes.

Capitalism is a totalising socio-economic dynamic (involving all aspects of human existence) and has an expansive character. Its intrinsic requirement, the expansion of value, is most effectively and securely realised through the appropriation of surplus value. Increasing value involves forcing, in a compelling and disordered manner, the spread of conditions that make the appropriation of surplus value possible; the owners of capital need to invest it in whatever human activity offers possibilities for its enlargement. This is the foundation of what is commonly called the commodification of life: the permanent creation of available masses of social beings in and for the market, robbed of whatever conditions that would allow them to secure their livelihood or to confront capital. They are thus fully in the market and need – and, therefore, want – to integrate themselves in it in order to make a living. They act as (free) workers in very different occupations through employment and contracts or in various precarious circumstances. In some cases, they are constrained to integrate themselves into the market through compulsory (legal or illegal) routes. They are necessarily consumers since they are only able to get the goods essential to life through the market. Although this perspective does not grasp all the dimensions of the phenomenon, it is crucial because it does not allow us to forget the concrete reality of the social beings that we are.

In summary, capital-imperialism results from the propagation and expansion of capitalism still in its classical form of imperialism but gestated under new conditions since World War II. Capital-imperialism expresses the exacerbation – economic, social and political – of a particular, unequal and combined form through which capitalism is precariously – and we should hope never completely